

The Cast

PUBLIC: EVERYONE MAY READ THIS

THE VICTIM

Bartholomew “Bart” Pringle

VP of Sales · nephew of founder Walt Evergreen · this year’s Secret Santa organizer. Bart was loud, generous with compliments in public and famous for a sweet tooth: any box of treats on Bart’s desk was opened within minutes. Bart organized this year’s Secret Santa and was widely expected to become CEO when Walt Evergreen retires in January. At 4:15 pm Bart opened a Secret Santa gift, a tin of peppermint fudge, ate two squares, and about twenty minutes later collapsed. The paramedics could not revive him.

Avery Quill · OFFICE MANAGER

CORE

Avery runs the building, the supply cabinet and this party. Avery booked the caterer, set up the Secret Santa gift table in the side hallway and has kept Evergreen & Pine running for nine years.

Seen wearing tonight: a reindeer-antler headband, clipboard in hand. **With Bart:** Planned the party with Bart, who chose this year’s Secret Santa theme.

Rowan Pike · FINANCE LEAD

CORE

Rowan keeps the books, the budgets and the company cards. Quiet, precise and famously calm at month-end, Rowan approves every supplier invoice and has stayed late all December closing out the year.

Seen wearing tonight: a cranberry-and-silver plaid scarf. **With Bart:** Sat across from Bart in every budget meeting this year.

Jesse Marlow · MARKETING LEAD

CORE

Jesse runs the website, the catalog and every photo shoot. Jesse spent the morning photographing holiday desserts for the website and brought a camera to the party.

Seen wearing tonight: a Santa hat and a camera strap. **With Bart:** Presented the new holiday campaign alongside Bart at the November sales meeting.

Kendall Brooks · TOP SALES REP

CORE

Kendall has topped the sales board three years running and knows every client by first name. Competitive, funny and never without a to-do list, Kendall reports to Bart.

Seen wearing tonight: a solid red scarf. **With Bart:** Reports directly to Bart.

Parker Lane · IT SUPPORT

CORE

Parker keeps the laptops, printers, website and today’s party projector running. Parker spent part of the afternoon fighting with the raffle slideshow.

Seen wearing tonight: a light-up holiday pin and a headset. **With Bart:** Fixes Bart’s laptop roughly once a week.

The Cast (continued)

OPTIONAL SUSPECTS MAY NOT BE PLAYING

Emerson Gray · HR DIRECTOR

CORE

Emerson looks after hiring, policies and the holiday bonus letters. Emerson is tonight's MC and gave the welcome speech at the cocoa toast.

Seen wearing tonight: a cream knit scarf and a holiday name badge. **With Bart:** Has worked with Bart for six years on hiring and staff events.

Skyler Moss · INTERN

OPTIONAL

Skyler joined as an intern in September and already knows where everything is. Skyler helped Bart run the Secret Santa sign-up and is the party's unofficial photographer.

Seen wearing tonight: a "Hello, I'm new!" lanyard. **With Bart:** Helped Bart organize the Secret Santa sign-up.

Drew Calder · CATERER

OPTIONAL

Drew runs Calder's Kitchen, the local caterer hired for the party. Drew set up the cocoa bar and dessert table and spent most of the afternoon in the kitchen.

Seen wearing tonight: a striped apron. **With Bart:** Has catered three Evergreen & Pine events that Bart booked.

Reese Whitfield · RIVAL COMPANY REP

OPTIONAL

Reese is a partnerships director at Whitfield Hampers, a competitor across town, invited by Bart as a "friendly client." Nobody else is quite sure why Reese is here.

Seen wearing tonight: a silver brooch. **With Bart:** Met Bart for lunch several times this fall.

Finley Dale · FOUNDER'S ASSISTANT

OPTIONAL

Finley manages Walt Evergreen's calendar, letters and the company's big decisions-in-waiting. Finley stood at Walt's side through the welcome toast.

Seen wearing tonight: a festive cardigan. **With Bart:** Schedules all of Bart's meetings with Walt.

ALSO AT THE PARTY

Detective Sam Holloway (played by the host) was in the building and is running the investigation. **Walt Evergreen**, the founder, gave the toast and is retiring in January. About twenty other staff (the guest cards) were at the party too.